

RentCast API Technical Analysis: Sold Properties for FirstKnock

1. /properties Endpoint — Complete Technical Profile

What it Returns and Data Sources

The `/properties` endpoint returns an array of detailed property record objects ^[1].

- **Data Sources:** Public county records, specifically Tax Assessor records, Deed records, and Property tax data ^[1].
- **Data Freshness Implication:** Because this endpoint relies on official county deed and tax records, the data is highly authoritative but subject to bureaucratic processing times. When a home is sold, the transaction must be officially recorded by the county clerk before it appears in this dataset.

The saleDateRange Parameter

This parameter is the primary mechanism for finding recently sold properties.

- **What it Measures:** It strictly measures the number of days since the property was **LAST SOLD**, referencing the `lastSaleDate` field derived from official deed records ^[1].
- **Range Syntax:** Supports a `min:max` format (e.g., `30:270` for properties sold between **30** and **270**days ago) ^[1].
- **Single-Value Behavior:** If a single numeric value is provided, it is treated as the **MAXIMUM** range value. For example, `saleDateRange=90` is executed as `*:90`, meaning properties sold within the last **90**days ^[1].

Data Freshness Lag Implication

Deed recording typically lags **30 to 90**days after the actual closing date.

***Implication for “90-day” queries:** If you query `saleDateRange=90`, you are asking for deeds recorded in the last **90**days. Because of the county lag, a home that closed **10**days ago likely will not appear in this query yet. You are effectively looking at a delayed snapshot of the market.*

Pagination Mechanics

- **Max Results:** Returns up to **500**records in a single API response ^[1].
- **Mechanics:** Controlled via the `limit` (max **500**) and `offset` (starting index) parameters ^[1]. To paginate, increment the `offset` by your `limit` value on each subsequent request (e.g., **0, 50, 100**) ^[1].

Key Response Fields for Sold-Home Identification

- `lastSaleDate` : The exact ISO 8601 date the property was last sold ^[1].
- `lastSalePrice` : The recorded sale price from the deed ^[1].
- `owner` : An object containing `owner.names` (array of current owners), `owner.type` , and `owner.mailingAddress` ^[1].
- `ownerOccupied` : A boolean indicating if the new owner lives at the property ^[1].
- `history` : An array of historical sale transactions ^[1].

2. /listings/sale Endpoint — Complete Technical Profile

What it Returns and Data Sources

The `/listings/sale` endpoint returns an array of property listing objects sourced directly from MLS (Multiple Listing Service) data ^[1]. It contains both active and inactive listings ^[1].

Status Parameter Values

- **Confirmed Values:** There are **ONLY TWO** possible status values: `Active` and `Inactive` ^[1].
- **Missing Values:** There is **NO** “Sold”, “Expired”, “Pending”, or “Contingent” status available in this endpoint ^[1].

What “Inactive” Means Precisely

An `Inactive` status simply means the property is “not currently listed on the market” ^[1]. Because there are no granular statuses, `Inactive` acts as a catch-all bucket that includes:

- Successfully sold homes
- Expired listings
- Withdrawn listings
- Cancelled listings

What daysOld Actually Filters

CRITICAL FLAW FOR SOLD SEARCHES: The `daysOld` parameter measures the number of days since the property was **LISTED ON THE MARKET**, referencing the `listedDate` field ^[1]. It does **NOT** measure the sale date or the removal date ^[1].

The lastSeenDate and removedDate Fields

- `lastSeenDate` : The date the property listing was most recently seen as active ^[1]. **The API sorts all returned listing records by this field in descending order** ^[1].
- `removedDate` : The date the property listing was most recently removed or delisted from the MLS ^[1]. For `Inactive` listings, this is the date it came off the market (whether it sold, ^e

expired, or was withdrawn).

Pagination Mechanics

- **Max Results:** Returns up to **500** listings per response ^[1].
- **Mechanics:** Uses the exact same `limit` and `offset` logic as the `/properties` endpoint ^[1].

Key Response Fields

- `status` : Active or Inactive ^[1].
- `listedDate` : When it hit the market ^[1].
- `removedDate` : When it came off the market ^[1].
- `lastSeenDate` : Last time the MLS broadcasted it as active ^[1].
- `daysOnMarket` : Total active days ^[1].
- `history` : Historical listing entries ^[1].

3. Critical Comparison: Which Endpoint Returns CONFIRMED SOLD Homes?

`/properties with saleDateRange`

- **PROS:** Filters on the actual deed-recorded sale date (`lastSaleDate`) ^[1]. These are **CONFIRMED** closed transactions.
- **PROS:** Returns highly valuable post-sale data, including the new homebuyer's name (`owner.names`) and whether they live there (`ownerOccupied`) ^[1].
- **CONS:** The **30-90** day deed recording lag means a "90-day" query (`saleDateRange=90`) will miss very recent closings and may only surface homes that closed **90-120+** days ago in reality.
- **CONS:** Lower result counts because the data takes longer to propagate through county systems.

`/listings/sale with status=Inactive`

- **PROS:** Yields a much larger result set (e.g., **215** vs **7-11**) because MLS data updates in real-time when a property is delisted.
- **CRITICAL FLAW:** Because `Inactive` equals sold + expired + withdrawn + cancelled, there is **NO WAY** to distinguish a successfully sold home from an expired listing using this endpoint alone ^[1].
- **CRITICAL FLAW:** The `daysOld` parameter filters on `listedDate` ^[1]. If a property was listed **400** days ago and finally sold last week, it would **NOT** appear in a `daysOld=90` query. Conversely, the **215** results include properties that were listed recently but were quickly

4. Explaining the 7-11 vs 215 Result Discrepancy

The massive discrepancy between the **7-11** results from `/properties` and the **215** results from `/listings/sale` in Las Cruces is **NOT** a data quality issue. It is the result of fundamentally different data sources and filter logic:

1. **The County Lag vs. MLS Real-Time:** The `/properties` endpoint only shows homes where the county clerk has officially recorded the deed. Due to the **30-90** day lag, the vast majority of homes sold in the last **90** days have not yet been digitized by the county.
2. **The “Inactive” Catch-All:** The **215** results from `/listings/sale` include every single home taken off the market in those ZIP codes. A large percentage of these are likely expired, withdrawn, or cancelled listings, not actual sales.
3. **The `daysOld` Trap:** If you used `daysOld=90` on the listings endpoint, you asked the API for homes *listed* in the last **90** days that are now inactive. You captured homes that hit the market and failed quickly, while completely missing homes that sold recently but were listed **100+** days ago.

5. Definitive Recommendation for FirstKnock.online

Primary Recommendation

To find **CONFIRMED** sold homes with actionable buyer data, FirstKnock.online **must use the** `/properties` **endpoint** with the `saleDateRange` parameter. This is the only way to guarantee a transaction occurred and to retrieve the new owner's name and occupancy status ^[1].

Data Freshness Warning & Recommended `saleDateRange`

To capture homes that actually closed within the last **90** days, you must account for the **30-90** day county recording lag.

Recommendation: Set the `saleDateRange` parameter to **180** (`saleDateRange=180`). This casts a wider net (up to **180** days ago) to ensure you capture deeds that closed **90** days ago but took **90** days to be recorded by the county.

Exact API Calls for Las Cruces, NM (180-day window)

ZIP Code 88001:

```
curl --request GET \
  --url 'https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?zipCode=88001&saleDateRange=180&limit=500' \
  --header 'Accept: application/json' \
  --header 'X-API-Key: YOUR_API_KEY'
```

ZIP Code 88005:

```
curl --request GET \
  --url
'https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?zipCode=88005&saleDateRange=180&limit=500' \
  --header 'Accept: application/json' \
  --header 'X-API-Key: YOUR_API_KEY'
```

ZIP Code 88012:

```
curl --request GET \
  --url
'https://api.rentcast.io/v1/properties?zipCode=88012&saleDateRange=180&limit=500' \
  --header 'Accept: application/json' \
  --header 'X-API-Key: YOUR_API_KEY'
```

The “Inactive + Cross-Reference” Strategy (Advanced)

If FirstKnock requires faster signals than the county can provide, you can use a two-step cross-reference strategy:

1. Query `/listings/sale` for `status=Inactive` and sort through the `removedDate` field locally to find properties taken off the market in the last **30days**.
2. Take the `formattedAddress` of those inactive listings and query the `/properties` endpoint specifically for those addresses (`?address=...`)^[1].
3. Check the `history` array or `lastSaleDate` of the property record^[1]. If the `lastSaleDate` matches the `removedDate` timeline, it was a sale. If not, it was likely an expired or withdrawn listing.

6. Summary Table

Dimension	/properties(saleDateRange)	/listings/sale(status=Inactive)
Data Source	Public County Records (Deeds/Tax)	MLS (Multiple Listing Service)
What “sold” filter measures	Days since lastSaleDate(Deed recorded)	Days since listedDate(Hit the market)
Confirms actual sale?	Yes(Official deed transfer)	No(Just means off-market)
Includes expired/withdrawn?	No(Only closed transactions)	Yes(All delisted properties)
Data freshness lag	30-90days (County processing time)	Real-time (MLS updates instantly)
Result count (Las Cruces	7-11(Accurate but delayed)	215(Inflated with non-sales)
Owner info available?	Yes(owner.names, ownerOccupied)	No(Only listing agent/office info)
Best for FirstKnock?	Primary Choice(Guarantees sales)	Secondary(Requires cross-referencing)

References

[1] "RentCast API Documentation Extractor".